

Get Your Body and Bank Account Right This Summer

EP 307

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter (Victory Talk Podcast, Ep. 307) delivers a practical summer action plan: track calories/macros with AI, spend four focused hours daily on your single highest-leverage activity, and fill every hour of your calendar — plus a stock market recap with analyst "Young Candlestick."

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Summer Urgency: The Ant and the Grasshopper

- Brandon opens by pointing out a common mindset trap: people give up on fitness goals by summer
- He observed overweight dads at a Disney cruise pool wearing shirts, accepting that as their identity
- "It doesn't have to be you" — summer is the time to lock in, not quit
- Uses the Aesop fable of the ant and the grasshopper as the core metaphor
- The grasshopper parties all summer while the ants work diligently
- When winter comes, the grasshopper dies; the ants survive
- Moral: use the warm months to build, not coast — "winter is coming"

- The promise: **90 days** of focused effort can put you in the best shape of your life AND generate significantly more disposable income

The Three Rules Framework

- Most people stay fat and broke because they confuse *motion* with *progress*
- Motion example (fitness): eating "healthy" smoothies without tracking calories — you can still get fat on healthy food
- Motion example (business): spending months debating a logo or business name instead of getting clients
- The fix is three rules applied simultaneously this summer: 1. Track everything that matters 2. Stop working on unimportant things; focus on what moves the needle 3. Live out of your calendar

Rule 1: Track Everything That Matters

- **Fat loss is pure math:** to lose 1 lb of fat you must burn 3,500 more calories than you consume
- 500 calorie/day deficit = 1 lb of fat lost per week ($500 \times 7 = 3,500$)
- 1,000 calorie/day deficit = 2 lbs of fat lost per week
- Step 1: Track calories *burned* — get a wearable device
- Options: Apple Watch, Garmin, Whoop, Oura Ring
- Brandon's current pick: **Oura Ring** — blends with all attire including formal wear; Apple Watch feels like "a big medical device"
- Devices aren't 100% accurate but provide a reliable enough range; you can calibrate over time
- Step 2: Track calories *consumed* — historically done with MyFitnessPal (Brandon used it 10+ years)
- Duke University study on tracking:
 - Researchers found a group of overweight subjects and had them use MyFitnessPal
 - No diet plan, no workout plan — just track what you eat
 - Result: subjects lost an **average of 5 pounds in 3 months** purely from awareness
 - Reason: seeing your intake in real time forces better decisions automatically
- Brandon has been a personal trainer for **27 years**; every client who starts tracking is shocked at how much or how little they actually eat
- Skinny guys who "can't gain muscle" are often eating only 1,500 calories/day
- Overweight clients who "tried everything" have never tracked once

Using Claude (AI) for Calorie Tracking

- Brandon is testing **Claude** as a replacement for MyFitnessPal — calls it potentially "the new wave"
- Also works with ChatGPT, but Claude has a unique advantage: it can connect to Apple Health data
- With Apple Health integration, Claude reads your calorie burn in real time and calculates your live surplus or deficit
- How the system works:

- Load a custom prompt into Claude (DM Brandon on Instagram the word **"tracking"** to receive the prompt and setup instructions)
- Throughout the day, tell Claude what you ate — by typing it or by uploading a photo of the food
- Claude returns macros, calories, and a running daily total alongside your burn data
- Example output: "Your current deficit for the day is 561 calories"
- Weighing food is still more accurate but photos work well too
- Brandon tested photo-estimated portions against actually weighed food — results were "in an acceptable range"
- At a catered barbecue where weighing was impractical, he photographed two plates of vegetables and received estimated macros
- Pro tip: tell the AI what you're eating (don't make it guess) — e.g., "steak, chicken breast, with hibachi sauce" — sauce details matter for accuracy
- End-of-day reconciliation: if the Claude burn estimate lags, upload a screenshot from the Oura Ring app; Claude recalculates with the more accurate figure
- Example: Claude showed 2,200 calorie burn; Oura Ring showed higher; after uploading screenshot, deficit recalculated to 940
- You can also photograph food packaging labels and drop them into the chat — no prompt needed, just upload the image

Simple Nutrition Formula for Getting Ripped

- **Calorie target:** body weight in pounds $\times 10$ = daily calorie goal
- Brandon = 200 lbs $\rightarrow$ 2,000 calories/day
- **Protein target:** body weight in pounds $\times 1$ = daily grams of protein
- Brandon = 200 lbs $\rightarrow$ 200 g protein/day (he typically hits 240 g)
- Brandon's personal macros while cutting: ~2,000–2,500 calories, 240 g protein, carbs kept under 50 g (keto), fats fill the rest
- For beginners in their first year of serious training: this formula allows simultaneous fat loss AND muscle gain ("newbie gains")
- For experienced trainees: the high protein target preserves muscle while cutting — prevents losing hard-earned muscle
- Key insight: "You cannot out-train a bad diet, but you can out-diet bad training" — diet is the most important variable

Workout Minimums for Fat Loss

- Cardio: 30–60 minutes of **steady-state cardio per day**
- Low intensity is fine — walking, stationary bike, elliptical
- Target pace: able to hold a conversation (not high-intensity)
- No need for HIIT, CrossFit, or Hyrox-style training unless you want to

- Resistance training: **3–4 full-body workouts per week**
- Choose 1–2 exercises per body part
- Do 3–4 sets per exercise
- That's it — keep it simple
- Bonus: use daily life (kids, activities) to add calorie burn; Brandon burned significant calories swimming with dolphins and water gun fighting at a barbecue

Rule 2: Work on the One Thing

- Source: the book *The One Thing* by Gary Keller
- At time of writing, the author was worth hundreds of millions; likely near billionaire status now
- Core premise: identify the single task that, if accomplished, makes everything else easier or unnecessary
- Brandon's application: after reading the book, he committed to **4 hours of content creation per day**
- Content was his "one thing" that made everything else in his online fitness business easier or unnecessary
- Result: made his **first million dollars** as an online trainer; has since taught over **15,000 people** to grow online fitness businesses
- Notable students: Austin Dunham, FedEx Fearless, Corey Armstrong
- Rules for the 4-hour daily block:
 - It must be *doing* the thing — not studying, watching YouTube, or reading about it (those are good but don't count toward the 4 hours)
 - Eliminate all distractions: turn off notifications, full focus
 - Does not have to be 4 consecutive hours — 2 hours morning + 2 hours evening is fine
 - Does not have to be exactly 4 hours every single day — it's an **average of 4 hours/day**
 - Miss Friday? Do 8 hours Saturday, or 6 hours each on Saturday and Sunday to compensate
- "If you put in four hours a day on the one thing, you will not fail. I promise you will succeed."
- Almost nobody actually does this — that's why almost nobody achieves their goals

Rule 3: Live Out of Your Calendar

- "I don't have time" is not true — "you're just not using it effectively"
- Tool: **Google Calendar** (only calendar Brandon recommends)
- Two types of tasks to schedule:
 - **Recurring tasks**: sleep, gym, meals, work, commute, family time — locked in and set to repeat
 - **One-time tasks**: may change weekly or daily; still get scheduled in advance
- Step-by-step calendar build (live demo in the episode): 1. Schedule sleep — example: 10 PM to 6 AM, set to repeat daily (regulates circadian rhythm) 2. Schedule work — example: 9 AM to 5 PM, repeat every weekday 3. Schedule commute — example: 1 hour each way (note: Brandon says commutes over 1 hour mean you need to move closer to work) 4. Schedule workout — 1 hour/day, every day, different color for

visibility 5. Schedule family time / date night — example: Tuesdays, color-coded pink 6. Schedule "one thing" deep work blocks — example: 2-hour blocks on weekdays you can manage, then 6-hour blocks on Saturday and Sunday to hit the weekly average of 28 hours (4 hrs/day × 7 days)

- "White space is the devil" — every open hour should be assigned a purpose
- Unexpected side effect of full calendar planning: **bad habits disappear automatically**
- Brandon quit weed and alcohol ~11 years ago not by trying to quit, but by filling his calendar — there was no slot for "Call of Duty weed smoking sessions" so they just stopped happening
- Everyone Brandon knows who starts living by their calendar sees their whole life change within **90 days** — he says he has never seen it fail
- You will make mistakes at first (misjudging how long tasks take) — stick with it and you'll calibrate over time

Stop Making Excuses (Kids, Girlfriends, Time)

- Kids as an excuse: "Your kids should be your motivation, not an excuse"
- Brandon hates hearing "I used to be in shape but then I had kids" — calls it unfair to burden children with your failure
- Kids enjoy being active with you: trampoline parks, walks, water gun fights, swimming — all burn real calories
- "Use it to your advantage" — wear your tracker during active play
- Girlfriend/wife cooking as an excuse: your mouth is your responsibility
- A friend (unnamed) got fat once he got a girlfriend because she cooked rich food and he lost motivation to stay lean
- Brandon's girlfriend cooks to support his goals and even weighs his food — but even without that, the accountability is yours
- "Not enough time" excuse: fully addressed by calendar planning — time exists, it just isn't being allocated

90-Day Challenge Summary

- Track calories consumed and calories burned (use Claude/ChatGPT with the tracking prompt — DM "tracking" on Instagram)
- Hit your calorie target (bodyweight × 10) and protein target (bodyweight × 1 gram)
- Do 30–60 min of steady-state cardio daily
- Do 3–4 full-body resistance training sessions per week
- Identify your "one thing" in business/career and spend an average of 4 focused hours/day on it
- Plan every hour of every day in Google Calendar — no white space
- Payoff by end of summer: best shape of your life, more disposable income, greater mental drive, more confidence, more respect from family and peers, better energy, longer life

Market Recap with Young Candlestick

- Co-analyst: "Young Candlestick" (Series 65 licensed)
- **90-day S&P 500 forecast**: base case is "a whole lot of nothing" — market bounced from oversold, now slightly overbought; no major upside or major selloff expected
- **Small caps (IWM)**: stair-stepping higher but forming a possible rising wedge; if it loses prior all-time highs, that's bearish
- **Semiconductors**: had a big -5% down day after a strong run; could see more softness/weakness in coming weeks
- **NBIS (Nebius — AI data centers)**: being added to NASDAQ 100 / QQQ — bullish catalyst
- Was flagged on a prior episode near \$215; now near all-time highs (~\$278)
- Up **210% year-to-date**; Young Candlestick still bullish long-term
- Only new entry point: buying the all-time high breakout above \$278
- **Crude oil**: sold off hard after Trump's peace deal; technical chart shows a rounding top; could get as low as **\$60/barrel** but Young Candlestick sees that as a buying dip; gas below \$3/gallon nationally may never happen again due to structural inflation
- **Bitcoin**: lower lows with a dead-cat bounce; not doing much
- **VIX**: spiked and came back down, forming a small bottom — could signal short-term market selling
- **FOMC meeting** (next day from recording): new Fed chair Worsh wants to raise rates → harder to borrow, slower business growth, but gradual cost-of-living reduction; market could spike hard in either direction — "basically like an earnings report"
- **SpaceX IPO**: SPCX went from \$149 to \$225; options now available but extremely expensive (pricing in high volatility)
- Preferred trade: selling **bullish put credit spreads at \$175** into Friday — risk ~\$450 to make ~\$50, ~90% probability of profit
- If it breaks all-time highs, potential gamma squeeze
- **Google**: Young Candlestick bought more today; Google owns **7% of SpaceX** — indirect exposure play; up ~20% YTD, near but not at highs
- **Apple**: performing well, slightly off all-time highs
- **Meta**: still well below all-time highs, stuck in consolidation
- **Netflix**: bleeding since last earnings; fair value ~\$120/share (implies ~50% upside from ~\$78); wait for stock to bottom and form a new chart structure before entering — possibly at \$85
- **Microsoft**: bought by Young Candlestick at \$390, averaged up at \$400; currently weak and "out of rotation" — unclear if short-term or structural
- **Caterpillar (CAT)**: breaking out to all-time highs — recommended industrial stock
- **TSM (Taiwan Semiconductor)**: favorite semiconductor; at \$425, target **\$1,000 in 3 years** (potential to reliably double); pays a dividend; options premiums are attractive for selling monthly bullish put credit spreads
- **Speculation**: Tesla, X (Twitter), and SpaceX may merge under one ticker symbol "X" — described as interesting to trade, not necessarily a strong investment thesis

- **Victory Trades** membership: daily trade alerts to your phone, live futures trading every morning; day trading PDT rule no longer applies — you need only ~\$2,000 in a margin account to trade in and out freely; recent member wins highlighted: \$200 on HIMS breakout, \$99 into \$550 (455% gain), \$837 on funded account

Super Chat Q&A

- **Book recommendation** (after *Rich Dad Poor Dad* and *Atomic Habits*): *Awaken the Giant Within* by Tony Robbins — read the physical book, NOT the audiobook (abridged/different content); one of Brandon's top-5 books ever
- **Jesse**: went keto + caffeine + Bronkaid, running 1,000 calorie deficit, not hungry, dropped from 19% to nearly 10% body fat — Brandon notes this stack mimics GLP-1 appetite suppression without the "Ozempic face" (muscle loss in the face from extreme appetite suppression)
- **Martin** (6'6", 265 lbs down from 298 lbs, no definition except traps): answer is body fat, not lack of lifting — men store more fat cells in the stomach; formula: stay under 3,000 calories/day, ~300 g protein; use AI photo tracking
- **Mike** (260 lbs, wants to reach 200 lbs by December): **yes, it's achievable** — ~24 weeks away
- At 1,000 cal/day deficit: lose 2 lbs/week × 24 weeks = ~48 lbs (just under goal)
- To hit exactly 60 lbs: add weekly **24-hour fasts** on top of the deficit
- Keto helps via ketone-driven appetite suppression but is not magic — calories still govern fat loss
- **Stephen** (how to get better at FX trading): practice using historical data — Brandon used **Ninja Trader** with downloaded historical data, practiced the market open session for 2 hours/day, hit **200 hours of simulated trading**, then received his first Apex payout of ~\$50,000
- **Andre** (down from 195 to 181, building a guitar lesson business): Brandon recognized him as the reviewer who recommended the **PRS Silver Sky SE** over the standard model (saving Brandon ~\$2,000); shoutout for Black Excellence
- **Martin** (follow-up, at 2,600 cal/day, 253 g protein, 20 min Stairmaster + 20 min dry sauna daily): Brandon says he sounds on the right track — keep the momentum

Sponsors and Offers

- **Free Live Training — June 28th (Sunday)**: how to grow an online fitness business using AI; 100% free; Brandon has made "tens of millions" as an online trainer and taught 15,000+ students; register via link in description
- **One-on-One Online Fitness Training with Brandon**: apply via second link in description; you'll receive an automated text — you MUST respond to that text or Brandon will ignore your application; personalized workout + diet plan with daily accountability
- **Victory Trades**: trade alerts + live futures trading community with Young Candlestick; link in description
- **Thought Repellent** (joke product): a spray to "keep the hoes away" — targeted for 4th of July release ("peak breeding season"); funding via super chats

- Brandon's **Instagram tracking prompt**: DM the word "tracking" to his Instagram (link in description) to receive his full Claude/ChatGPT calorie tracking prompt and setup instructions — free